Merrill Kelly

RHP · AZ · 2026 · 2,626 pitches

Family 1: Low slot, true to slot

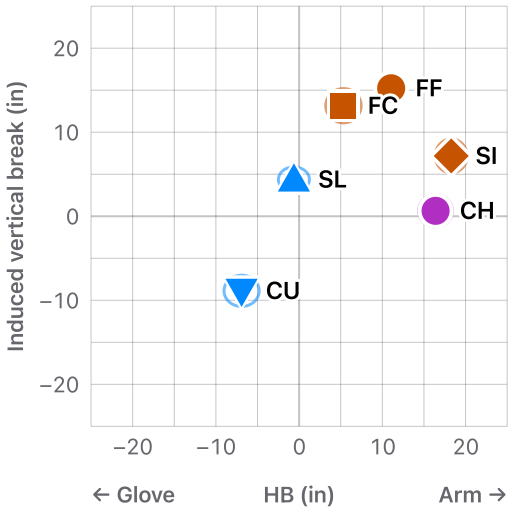
1 | 20° Slot | 85% Efficiency | +5° Tilt | 26 BU Spin

Low slot, true to slot | Reference: Four-seam

1:45

Low slot (21°) with a four-seam that sits true to the slot (+3°), spun with some gyro (85% efficient), with high spin for its velocity (26 BU).

Arsenal Movement



Averages with one-standard-deviation ovals. Drawn from behind the pitcher: arm side is to the right.

Top Recommendations

- ● Sinker: Ceiling 102, now 95 (gap +7). The best reachable shape is 6.0 in IVB and 21.0 in arm side. Main lever: grip / seam orientation. The seam effect is in the 37th percentile of comps who throw it. Confidence: High (19 comps).
- ● Four-seam: little room left from the current setup (Ceiling 96, now 95). Confidence: High (25 comps).
- ◐ Slider: Ceiling 116, now 96 (gap +19). The best reachable shape is −5.0 in IVB and 7.0 in glove side. Main lever: hand position at release. Confidence: Medium (15 comps).

Top Five Comps

Zack Wheeler (2025)	1 | 25/85/0/26	96
Noah Schultz (2026)	1 | 20/85/0/26	93
Alex McFarlane (2026)	1 | 25/85/+5/26	90
Yimi García (2023)	1 | 25/85/0/26	88
Cole Sands (2023)	1 | 25/85/0/25	87

Every Pitch: Today and Potential

Pitch	Usage	Velo	Spin	IVB	HB	Stuff+	Ceiling	Gap	Main Lever	Conf.
Changeup	28%	88.5	2165	0.6	16.4	112	112	0	Grip / Seam Orientation	◐
Four-seam	27%	92.1	2366	15.2	11.1	95	96	+1	Grip / Seam Orientation	●
Cutter	14%	91.0	2367	13.2	5.3	92	95	+2	Grip / Seam Orientation	◐
Curveball	11%	82.5	2575	−8.9	−6.9	101	110	+9	Hand Position at Release	◐
Slider	10%	86.3	2318	4.4	−0.6	96	116	+19	Hand Position at Release	◐
Sinker	9%	92.4	2240	7.2	18.3	95	102	+7	Grip / Seam Orientation	●

Velocity in mph, spin in rpm, movement in inches (IVB: induced vertical break; HB: horizontal break from behind the pitcher, arm side positive).

Confidence and Data Notes

Stuff+ is Spin ID's own model, not FanGraphs Stuff+. 100 is the 2021–2024 average pitch. Ceiling: what this pitcher's comps do with each pitch, at this pitcher's own velocity and release; Gap is Ceiling minus today; the lever is the change that adds the most. Fastballs keep their natural spin.

Confidence (● High, ◐ Medium, ○ Low) is how much real MLB data sits behind each estimate. Estimates, not promises.

Validity test T5 passed: Stuff+ in 2025 lined up with 2026 results at r = 0.21, better than velocity alone (0.09) and 2025 results (0.09), over 1,247 pitches.

Tested (T4, 2025 to 2026): bigger gaps came with only slightly bigger next-season Stuff+ gains (partial r 0.07; the range includes zero), so treat a gap as a direction to explore, not a forecast.

2026 season: 2,616 pitches with a pitch type; the Spin ID comes from 719 four-seams. Comps are the nearest Spin IDs (slot, efficiency, tilt offset, spin) among MLB pitcher-seasons 2021–2026.

Spin ID · Schema v1 (frozen 2026-10-11) · stuff-1 · physics-1 · transition-1 · movement-1 · parks-1

Data: MLB Statcast via Baseball Savant. 2026. Printed Oct 13, 2026.